

STATE OF NEW YORK

5764--A

2025-2026 Regular Sessions

IN SENATE

February 28, 2025

Introduced by Sen. SKOUFIS -- read twice and ordered printed, and when printed to be committed to the Committee on Environmental Conservation -- recommitted to the Committee on Environmental Conservation in accordance with Senate Rule 6, sec. 8 -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee

AN ACT to amend the environmental conservation law, in relation to establishing the wastewater infrastructure and drinking water program; and making an appropriation therefor

The People of the State of New York, represented in Senate and Assembly, do enact as follows:

Section 1. The environmental conservation law is amended by adding a new section 3-0322 to read as follows:

§ 3-0322. Wastewater infrastructure and drinking water program.

1. Notwithstanding any other provisions of this chapter or any other law, rule or regulation, and subject to an appropriation made therefor and in accordance with the provisions of this section and with the rules and regulations promulgated by the commissioner in connection therewith, on and after the first day of April, in the year next succeeding the effective date of this section, a wastewater infrastructure and drinking water program is hereby established for the purpose of making payments toward the replacement and rehabilitation of existing local municipally-owned and funded drinking water, storm water and sanitary sewer systems. For purposes of this section, such program shall apply to any drinking water system, storm water system or sanitary sewer system within the state that is under the maintenance and/or operational jurisdiction of a county, city, town, village or public authority; provided, however, that such system shall not be under the maintenance and/or operational jurisdiction of a private entity. The commissioner, in conjunction with the environmental facilities corporation, shall promulgate all necessary rules and regulations to carry out the program so

EXPLANATION--Matter in italics (underscored) is new; matter in brackets [-] is old law to be omitted.

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1 that an equitable distribution of aid shall be made for the general
2 operation and/or general maintenance of any such existing drinking water
3 system, storm water system or sanitary sewer system.

4 2. Such program shall offer grants to municipalities to help pay for
5 the initial planning of eligible Clean Water State Revolving Fund
6 (CWSRF) water quality projects.

7 3. Funding may be used by municipalities for the preparation of an
8 engineering report. This includes planning activities to determine the
9 scope of water quality issues, evaluation of alternatives, and the
10 recommendation of a capital improvement project. In addition, the costs
11 to conduct an environmental review for the recommended alternative are
12 eligible. Design and construction costs are not eligible. Priority shall
13 be given to municipalities proposing planning activities that are:

14 (a) required by an executed Order on Consent; or

15 (b) required by a draft or final State Pollutant Discharge Elimination
16 System (SPDES) permit (e.g. nutrient removal, inflow and infiltration,
17 disinfection); or

18 (c) upgrading or replacing an existing wastewater system; or

19 (d) constructing a wastewater treatment and/or collection system for
20 an area with failing onsite septic systems; or

21 (e) addressing a pollutant of concern in a watershed implementation
22 plan (i.e. Total Maximum Daily Load (TMDL), Nine Element Watershed Plan,
23 or DEC HABS Action Plan).

24 § 2. The sum of five million dollars (\$5,000,000) is hereby appropri-
25 ated to the department of environmental conservation out of any moneys
26 in the state treasury in the general fund, not otherwise appropriated,
27 and made immediately available, for the purposes of providing emergency
28 municipal drinking water, wastewater and storm water infrastructure
29 grants for infrastructure projects where there is an imminent threat to
30 the environment and/or the public health, specifically for the wastewa-
31 ter infrastructure and drinking water program. Such moneys shall be
32 payable on the audit and warrant of the comptroller on vouchers certi-
33 fied or approved by the department of environmental conservation.

34 § 3. This act shall take effect on the one hundred twentieth day after
35 it shall have become a law.